

Report conversation

Which of these is more correct?

> The list contains none of X, Y, Z, or W

vs.

> The list contains none of X, Y, Z, and W

Both sentences are grammatically correct, but they convey slightly different meanings:

- "The list contains none of X, Y, Z, or W" suggests that the list does not contain any one of those elements, potentially leaving open the possibility that it could contain some combination of the others.
- "The list contains none of X, Y, Z, and W" implies a more collective exclusion, meaning the list does not contain X, does not contain Y, does not contain Z, and does not contain W, with a stronger emphasis that all are excluded.

In everyday use, especially in contexts where precision is not critical, the distinction is often overlooked, and both forms are used interchangeably. However, if precision is important, such as in legal or technical writing, the distinction could be significant.